

Linux Foundation launches a new project to secure software-defined networks

The Linux Foundation has announced the Open Security Controller (OSC) project, a software-defined orchestration solution for multi-cloud environments.

Software-defined networks are becoming a standard for businesses. With the high penetration of open source projects, the automated network is becoming quite important. The OSC project by the Linux Foundation tries to address this requirement by offering automation along with security. The project is touted to deliver maximum network security in the current as well as future releases.

Linux developers have enabled the OSC project to provide data centre security that is not only scalable but also reduces threats in software-defined network environments. The open source development also reduces the effort required to ensure security compliances. Organisations are free to modify the code to implement the security technology that suits their needs.

"Equally important to automation in the open source community is ensuring security," said Arpit Joshipura, GM of networking and orchestration at The Linux Foundation. "The Open Security Controller Project touches both these areas. We are excited to have this project join The Linux Foundation, and look forward to the collaboration this project will engender regarding network security now and in the future," he added.

The official announcement by the Linux Foundation hints at the automated deployment of virtualised network security functions such as firewalls, intrusion prevention systems and application data controllers.

Licensed under Apache 2, the project works with an independent governing board and technical steering committee. It is the result of collaborative efforts driven by Intel, Huawei, Nudge Networks, Palo Alto Networks and McAfee.

as a base for products and services that incorporate deep learning," company sources said in a statement.

The deep learning framework has been used in Sony's SmartAR app AR Effect, the activity tracker Lifelog and the contract price prediction solution Price Estimation Engine.

Sony has extensively used the library on Ubuntu 16.04, as well as in Windows 8 and 10 machines. The framework seems quite similar to existing frameworks like TensorFlow, Then and (Py)Torch, though Sony claims its offering is unique. The Japanese company has not overtly made any comparisons with other tools. Also, the USP of the framework has not been revealed officially.



Sony has taken the open source way to bring developers on board and expand into the emerging deep learning space. It has acquired AI company Cogital, to counter Apple, Google and Samsung.

You can access the Neural Network Libraries code from Sony's Nnabla repository on GitHub. The code includes a layer of Python interface functions alongside the C++ core libraries.

GitHub launches 'Open Source Friday' initiative to encourage community contributions

GitHub has announced a new initiative called 'Open Source Friday' to encourage individual developers and companies to focus on contributing to open source. GitHub believes that the initiative is not just about giving your employees some free time to work on their open source projects but will also help companies improve their business infrastructure.

The idea of launching the Open Source Friday initiative germinated when GitHub observed that a lot of people are willing to contribute to open source projects, but they do not have the time to develop their contributions. The new move gives room for contributors to spend at least two hours every Friday, working on an open source project. "Open Source Friday is not limited to individuals. Your team, department, or company can take part, too. Contributing to the software you already use isn't altruistic—it is an investment in the tools your company relies on," GitHub's team wrote in a blog post. GitHub will let users set up their profile pages and feature the work done under the Open Source Friday initiative. All developers have been invited to join this new initiative.

SUSE Manager 3.1 optimises enterprise DevOps and IT operations

SUSE has released SUSE Manager 3.1 as its new DevOps and container management solution for enterprises. The new offering is designed to boost DevOps efficiency while managing containers.

Positioned as an important component in SUSE's software-defined infrastructure portfolio, the new SUSE Manager is aimed at reducing the complexity of enterprises and helping them become more efficient and agile when meeting customer demands. It comes with an enhanced management of software templates, and complies with container and cloud infrastructure standards. Also, the tool improves the control over IT assets by graphically visualising the deployed systems and their relationships.

"SUSE Manager lets IT organisations be more agile and optimises their